Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + cisplatin

Induction: all three medicines on Day 1 every 21 days for up to four cycles. Maintenance: cisplatin stops; pembrolizumab and pemetrexed may continue every 21 days while appropriate. The team agrees duration and review points.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hormones / brain

Pembrolizumab

Unusual weakness, dizziness, headache, thirst or frequent urination: report promptly.

2 Lungs

Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment; infection, cancer or clot can look similar.

3 Heart

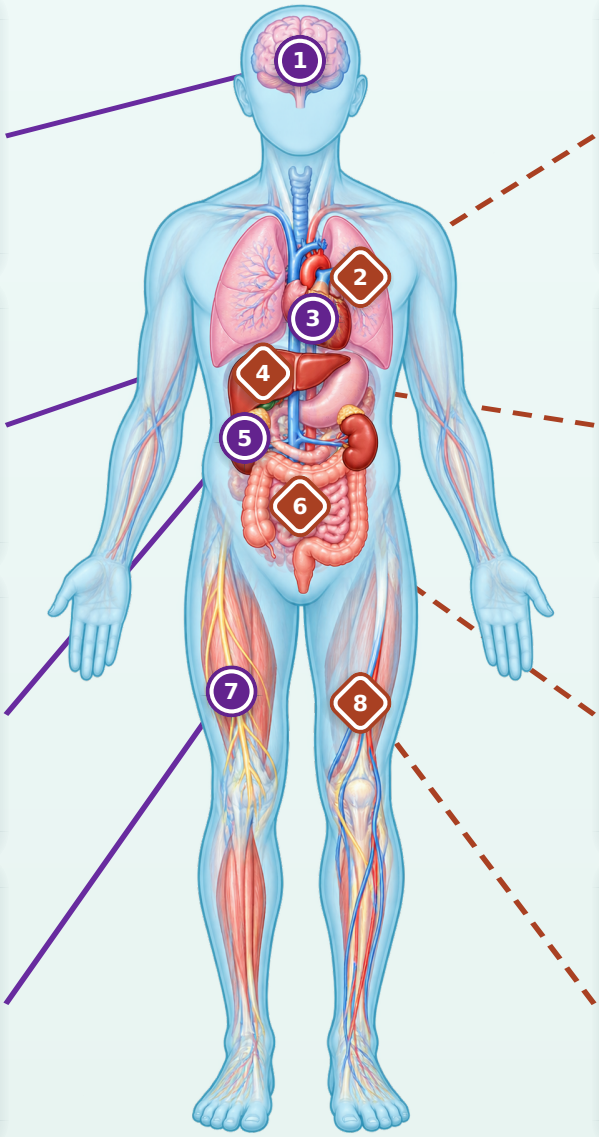
Pembrolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

4 Liver

Pembrolizumab / pemetrexed

Yellow skin/eyes or dark urine; tests also check changes before symptoms.



5 Kidneys

Pembrolizumab / cisplatin / pemetrexed

Report much less urine, swelling or persistent vomiting; kidney results affect treatment.

6 Bowel / mouth

Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

New diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, mouth ulcers or inability to drink need advice.

7 Skin / nerves

Pembrolizumab / cisplatin

Report rash, blisters, numbness, weakness or problems with balance or hand function.

8 Blood / infection

pemetrexed / cisplatin

Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell: contact oncology immediately.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Pembrolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys, glands, skin and other organs
- Serious infusion reactions
- Effects can develop after treatment ends

Pemetrexed

- Low blood counts and infection
- Fatigue, nausea, mouth soreness and rash
- Kidney toxicity; folate and B12 supplementation are required

Cisplatin

- Nausea and vomiting
- Kidney injury and electrolyte changes
- Hearing loss or tinnitus
- Numbness/tingling and other nerve effects
- Low blood counts and infection

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Induction support

You receive anti-sickness medicines and a fluid plan around cisplatin. Take prescribed folic acid, B12 injections and rash-prevention steroids. Ask for one clear steroid schedule.

Maintenance support

Folic acid, B12 and rash-prevention medicines continue with pemetrexed; cisplatin fluids and some anti-sickness medicines may stop. Immune symptom vigilance continues.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00569/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.